PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Chevrolet K5 Blazer (1st generation)

1969–1972 · K5 · GMC Jimmy · KE/KS-1550

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Rust first, drivetrain second**
  Velocity Restorations lists the floorboards, wheel wells, inner fenders and door bottoms as the usual rust spots. The Drive adds the top of the windshield frame. Fresh paint can hide all of it, so bring a magnet and look underneath.
- [ ] **Inspect the frame at the steering box**
  Offroad Design says straight-axle GM trucks are notorious for frame cracks where the steering box mounts, especially with lifts, big tires and off-road use. Look for cracks and old weld repairs on the driver's-side rail ahead of the front axle.
- [ ] **Is the top there, and does it fit?**
  Many first-gen trucks have lost their hardtop or soft top. The Drive notes that the fiberglass top's textured finish is hard to match in repairs. Check the top's mounting edge, the liftgate and the seals, because a leaky or missing top is expensive to sort out.
- [ ] **Work out what has been swapped**
  Recent BaT results include LS, Vortec, 383, 454 and 6.2 L swaps alongside original trucks. Velocity advises caution unless swap work is documented and done by a qualified builder. Decide whether you're paying for originality or for the build.
- [ ] **Read the SPID decal**
  Factory equipment and paint are listed on the Service Parts Identification decal inside the glovebox, per a 1969 BaT listing. Use it to check a claimed CST, Positraction or V8 truck.
- [ ] **Expect a loose chassis**
  The Drive warns that the chassis is flexible and the steering has play, and that a big power upgrade can make the handling worse. Budget for steering-box, tie-rod and bushing work, and drive it before you agree a price.
- [ ] **Check which transfer case and hubs it has**
  Manual trucks may have the Dana 20 or the NP205. Automatic trucks have the NP205. Offroad Design notes the NP205's tag sits above the front output and that the case is one piece of cast iron. Make sure the hubs lock and unlock.
- [ ] **Mind the brakes on 1969–70 trucks**
  Front discs became standard for 1971. Earlier trucks have four-wheel drums unless they've been converted, so ask what has been changed and how well it was done.

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **First gen vs square body**
  1969–72 trucks use the Action Line pickup front end and body on a 104 in wheelbase. 1973–75 square bodies also have a full removable top, but sit on a 106.5 in wheelbase with the new 1973 sheet metal.
- [ ] **Year by grille**
  Per CK5: 1969 has an aluminum center piece embossed CHEVROLET with built-in rectangular parking lamps; 1970 has six groups of silver 'dashes'; 1971 has an egg-crate grille; on 1972 the grille surround is no longer black. Grilles are easy to swap, so cross-check the title year and VIN.
- [ ] **SPID decal**
  The Service Parts Identification decal inside the glovebox lists factory options and paint (BaT 1969 listing). Use it to check CST trim, Positraction and engine claims.
- [ ] **GMC Jimmy series codes**
  GMC's 1971 brochure lists the Jimmy as CE-1550 and CS-1550 (two-wheel drive) and KE-1550 and KS-1550 (4×4).
- [ ] **Transfer case and brakes**
  Manual trucks may have a Dana 20 or an NP205; automatics have the NP205 (one-piece iron case, three-bolt idler cover, tag above the front output). Front discs are original only on 1971–72 trucks.

NOTES

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